

to modify the UI easily, add or change functionality, and integrate third-party applications as long as they are web-ready and cloud-ready. This flexibility allows our partners to tailor the offering according to their needs, whether they are SaaS providers, telcos, or large enterprises with their own branding and representation of the product.

Q. What are the technological differences between your suite of software and the proprietary ones?

A. When comparing open source solutions like ours with proprietary ones such as Microsoft and Google, there are notable distinctions. For instance, Microsoft and Google focus on user interfaces that may not align with professional organisational needs. Consider the example of Gmail, where tags are emphasised for email organisation, whereas some users prefer the structure provided by folders. Similarly, tools like Google Task Manager might lack the functionalities required for effective team organisation in a business setting. While these platforms offer modern and technologically advanced features, they are centrally hosted, requiring users to place complete trust in providers like Google, Microsoft, Oracle, or Salesforce. This centralised hosting model raises concerns, especially in security-related businesses where trust is a critical factor. From a technological perspective, platforms like Google Angular provide excellent front-end technology, but the key distinction is the ability to use such technologies under our control. This approach involves leveraging open source components, enabling development and hosting within our customers' data centres. In the case of Microsoft, products like MS Exchange and MS SharePoint, despite their historical significance, may struggle to keep up with the evolving landscape. Attempting to modernise older systems proves challenging,

and there is need for a fresh start to stay in line with the rapidly advancing technology landscape.

Q. How would you explain or convince your prospective customers (CIOs and the IT decision-makers), who are evaluating your solutions with respect to other solutions, to buy your product?

A. We bring modernity and innovation. Open systems consistently outperform closed systems, as in the case of Tesla, which operates as an open source company, even sharing its so-called patents. Security is the second crucial factor. How can a US company assure its customers, held accountable by the Cloud Act, that their data is secure? Similarly, convincing an Indian government institution that their data is safe in the US is a dubious claim. Lastly, total cost of ownership (TCO) is a key consideration.

Operating on Linux and Kubernetes, our stack requires significantly fewer resources compared to Microsoft's often outdated components. For instance, Microsoft Exchange is decades old, whereas we leverage state-of-the-art web, cloud, and SaaS technologies. If the functionality is comparable to Microsoft and these three aspects are considered, many large industry-leading customers approach us. We have invested a decade building this suite and are now entering the market with full force, partnering with companies like Intel, Fujitsu, and Bechtle AG, Germany's largest independent IT systems integrator. Bechtle AG has selected our product as a strategic offering to address their extensive customer base with a new technology based on open source. In Europe, the open source movement is gaining momentum, and we anticipate significant growth in the next two to three years. The prediction is that open source will dominate the entire space of communication and collaboration, with VNC being a leader in this transformation.

Q. Why do we see companies such as Intel, whose main business is very proprietary in nature, venture into the open source space?

A. From our point of view, Intel is well aware that open source technology, along with the associated engineering and development practices, represents the future—a future they must embrace. While they currently hold a substantial market share, making them the undisputed leader, they recognise the need to adapt. In the rapidly evolving landscape of SaaS and cloud environments, where major players like Google and Apple are developing their own chips and processors, staying ahead requires vigilance. With VNClaagoon we can use so-called confidential computing based on Intel Software Guard Extensions (SGX) to handle data confidentiality during storage, transmission and, for the first time, during processing through encryption. The hardware-protected process ensures that access to such data is only possible for the client, thereby minimising the risk of accidental data leaks. By running various microservices of the VNClaagoon implementation in SGX enclaves, increased protection of data during processing was achieved. As the central 'guard' of the VNClaagoon deployment, the so-called NGINX Ingress Controller of the Kubernetes cluster was first protected in this way. Work is also underway to protect key management in Hashicorp's vault and encapsulate the central user database.

For instance, the technology we employ to encrypt compute processes within the processor, known as Grammine, is part of an open source community. This open approach is crucial for ensuring secrecy and privacy around processor technology. While Intel may not open up its patents currently, the surrounding software is entirely open source, a practice we value and appreciate.